

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, freight intelligence.*

Positioning, experienced Product Manager with 13 years in complex operational domains, ready to digitise freight workflows and ship AI-powered supply chain features at Zencargo.

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§ WHY ZENCARGO

Zencargo sits at the intersection of two things I find genuinely hard and genuinely interesting: operationally complex workflows that still run on email and spreadsheets, and AI applied to real exception management rather than demo slides. Luca as an AI co-pilot for freight forwarding is exactly the kind of product bet I would want to own, not a bolt-on chatbot, but a co-pilot woven into booking, shipment, and purchase-order workflows where the cost of a missed exception is measurable in euros and days. The posting calls out that product areas include operational automation and AI-powered productivity features, which maps directly to the work I did instrumenting competing workflows at Rohde & Schwarz and then redirecting strategy based on what the data actually showed. *That is the environment where careful discovery and fast delivery compound into something real.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, paired coding and edge-case coverage
- **Cursor**, codebase navigation and rapid prototyping
- **Lovable**, throwaway UI prototypes in discovery
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes and stakeholder demos
- **Gamma.app**, async communication and research synthesis

- **GPT**, user interview analysis and draft requirements
 - **n8n**, agentic workflow automation and LLM orchestration
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Dagster, dbt, ETL design, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, SQL, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Git, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built solo from zero to one.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protects both sides until commitment, removing the headhunter from the hire.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface; LLM agents across the acquisition and matching funnel.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; one operator running the full day-to-day.
 - Demonstrates exactly the pattern Zencargo needs: complex operational workflow, multi-sided stakeholders, and AI reducing manual coordination overhead.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT ZENCARGO

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow freight operations and customer success to map the actual booking and exception-management workflows end to end, identifying where manual handoffs, email, and spreadsheets are doing the heaviest lifting.

WEEK 2

Instrument, then prioritise.

Run structured user interviews with operational and customer-facing users and layer in product data to rank the top friction points by frequency and cost, producing a first prioritised problem list I can defend with evidence.

WEEK 3+

Own and ship.

Take clear ownership of one initiative, define success measures before build starts, partner with the design and engineering squad through discovery and delivery, and close the loop with adoption and outcome tracking after launch.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Zencargo team,

Freight forwarding is one of the last large operational domains where the daily reality for most participants is still email threads, spreadsheet trackers, and institutional knowledge held in individual heads. That gap between what software could do and what is actually running in production is where I have consistently found the most tractable product problems. Thirteen years of product ownership across operationally complex domains, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, payments, has taught me that the most valuable moves are rarely the flashiest features; they are the workflow redesigns that remove a manual step someone has been doing every day for years.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme. The defining moment of that engagement was instrumenting two competing approaches to a pipeline workflow: a well-designed UI-first path and a developer-code-first alternative. The UI path recorded exactly zero clicks in production. I redirected the roadmap accordingly, and pipeline runs increased by 200%. That discipline, agreeing what success looks like before building, then checking honestly whether it happened, is what I would bring to Zencargo's booking, shipment, and operational automation areas.

At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national labour-market analytics platform and introduced Dagster and dbt to replace manual data update processes, saving close to 75% of the time per quarterly import. The pattern maps directly to what Zencargo is doing: take a process that experts have been running by hand, model it properly, automate the repeatable parts, and surface exceptions to the people best placed to resolve them. That is also how I read the Luca AI co-pilot, not automation for its own sake, but exception management that puts the right information in front of a freight operator before the problem compounds.

I have been using AI tools as working infrastructure for the past two years: Claude Code for in-repo refactors and spec generation, Lovable for throwaway discovery prototypes, n8n for agentic workflow automation, and GPT for user interview synthesis and requirements drafting. My master's specialisation at TU Berlin was logistics, which gives me a structural understanding of the supply chain domain alongside the product and technical experience I have built since. I am comfortable working with ambiguity, challenging established processes, and making prioritisation calls with incomplete information, which is the only kind of information that exists in a fast-moving freight environment.

I would welcome the chance to talk through how my background fits the specific product areas Zencargo is investing in right now.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager with 13 years of ownership in operationally complex, regulated domains. I run continuous discovery, turn user workflows and technical constraints into prioritised roadmaps, and lead cross-functional squads through agile delivery without heavy documentation overhead. My most productive pattern: instrument competing approaches cheaply, read what the data actually says, and redirect before sinking build budget into the wrong path. Looking to apply that discipline to logistics and supply chain automation at Zencargo.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, prototyping, A/B testing, user research and interviews, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt (data build tool), Matomo, MicroStrategy, PostgreSQL, SQL.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART, PI planning, CI/CD, GitOps, ArgoCD.

SaaS Platform and Technical Environments: Kubernetes, Docker, REST APIs, Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Jenkins, Azure DevOps.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout from days to 30 minutes; redirected roadmap after instrumenting competing workflows, lifting pipeline runs 200%; led 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum on FCAS.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt to a national labour-market analytics platform, saving ~75% per data update cycle; migrated bare-metal to containers and carried a full UI relaunch and ETL migration simultaneously. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 01/2023-07/2023

Cut roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose fivefold; integrated CGM hospital interface, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS PLATFORM 2022-2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure; shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut insurance product time-to-market from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS, POS
2021-2022

Moved research results into production in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · SECURE GOVERNMENT
DATA PLATFORM 03/2021-06/2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute's DIM and DESH programmes.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B SAAS
2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement webshop to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL
NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-PRESENT

Zero to one: two-sided B2B marketplace, anonymity-until-payment model, LLM agents across the funnel, SQL-based conversion analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer hardware-software product that installs in under two minutes; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY AND AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · ZENCARGO

